win the goodwill of India's other neighbour, Sri Lanka.

During both her terms, Mrs. Gandhi had tried to improve India's relation with China. She met Hua Guofeng, the then Chinese Prime Minister in Belgrade in 1980 and later Premier Zhau Ziyang at Cancun in 1981. Beijing also made efforts for the betterment of relations to that end and sent, one of its senior Vice Premiers, Huang Hua to New Delhi in June 1981.

India again faced another dilemma when the Soviet Union invaded a non-aligned country like Afghanistan. It was a tightrope walk for India. India's response to the Afghanistan issue disappointed the Americans as they thought New Delhi would come down heavily on the presence of the Soviet troops in Afghanistan. India again was vocal against the US supply of the most advanced and lethal armaments to Pakistan as a part of its containment policy. It was only during the Cancun Summit that President Ronald Reagan and Mrs. Gandhi evolved a good personal equation that served to limit the damage caused.

India also hosted the Seventh NAM Summit in 1983 and Mrs. Gandhi was elected as the Chairperson for the next three years. The 1982 Asian Games was another achievement of Mrs. Gandhi's government. In 1983 Commonwealth Heads of Government Meeting (CHOGM) was held in New Delhi. These events showed that India was gaining a prominent position in the international arena.

The Janata Party (1977–1979): Good Neighbourly Policy

The Janata Party came to power for a very brief period from 1977 to 1979. This was the first non-Congress government formed under Morarji Desai since the time of Nehru. It was expected that there would be drastic changes in the foreign policy posture of India under the Janata Government. This was specially so because they vehemently criticized India's intimacy with the Soviet Union as a violation of the principle of non-alignment. On the Janata Party's assumption of office, the leaders talked about genuine non-alignment and maintaining distance from both the superpowers. But soon they were disillusioned as Jimmy Carter's Government refused shipment of enriched uranium to Tarapore plant on the ground that